Gulf Cybersecurity Baseline

Readiness report

The Arabian Gulf against exploited vulnerabilities

Census of 26 October 2026

What the public websites of the six states announce about their software, held against CISA's catalogue of exploited vulnerabilities and against the support cycles their makers publish.

Key figures

85.3% of live domains answered with their first page

11,776 / 13,803

57.0% of the sites announcing a full Apache HTTP Server version announce one affected by CVE-2024-38475

90 of 158 announcing a full version

88.4% of the sites announcing a nginx version run one past its support

425 of 481 announcing a version

30.0% of the sites read announce the version of at least one piece of software

3,531 of 11,776 whose first page was read



Bahrain at night, photographed by NASA from the International Space Station on 8 December 2010.

Exploited vulnerabilities

Every vulnerability CISA has added to its catalogue of exploited vulnerabilities that affects software announced from outside, newest first, with the share of sites announcing an affected version among the sites that announce a version.

Share	Vulnerability	Affected of announcing	Catalogued
57.0%	**Apache HTTP Server CVE-2024-38475** Apache HTTP Server Improper Escaping of Output Vulnerability	90 / 158	1 May 2025
0.4%	**PHP CVE-2024-4577** PHP-CGI OS Command Injection Vulnerability Used in ransomware campaigns	5 / 1,192	12 June 2024
0.0%	**OpenSSL CVE-2014-0160** OpenSSL Information Disclosure Vulnerability	0 / 36	4 May 2022
0.3%	**PHP CVE-2012-1823** PHP-CGI Query String Parameter Vulnerability	3 / 1,192	25 March 2022
0.0%	**Drupal CVE-2020-13671** Drupal core Un-restricted Upload of File	0 / 66	18 January 2022
0.0%	**Apache HTTP Server CVE-2021-42013** Apache HTTP Server Path Traversal Vulnerability Used in ransomware campaigns	0 / 158	3 November 2021
0.0%	**Apache HTTP Server CVE-2021-41773** Apache HTTP Server Path Traversal Vulnerability Used in ransomware campaigns	0 / 158	3 November 2021
9.5%	**Apache HTTP Server CVE-2019-0211** Apache HTTP Server Privilege Escalation Vulnerability	15 / 158	3 November 2021
0.0%	**Drupal CVE-2018-7600** Drupal Core Remote Code Execution Vulnerability Used in ransomware campaigns	0 / 89	3 November 2021
0.3%	**Microsoft IIS CVE-2017-7269** Microsoft Windows Server Buffer Overflow Vulnerability	2 / 615	3 November 2021

And 7 more in Apache Tomcat and Joomla, which no site announces a full version of, so they are not measured yet.

Software past its support

Among the sites that announce the version of their software, the share running a version its maker no longer supports according to endoflife.date, so it receives no security patches.

Share	Software	Past support of announcing	Most common cycles
0.3%	WordPress	4 / 1,552	7.1 · 7.0 · 6.9
29.4%	PHP	351 / 1,192	8.3 · 8.2 · 7.4
3.7%	Microsoft IIS	23 / 615	10.0 · 8.5 · 7.5
88.4%	nginx	425 / 481	1.29 · 1.24 · 1.18
2.4%	Apache HTTP Server	4 / 170	2.4 · 2.2
12.4%	Drupal	13 / 105	7
77.8%	OpenSSL	28 / 36	1.0.2 · 1.1.1 · 3.5

What sites announce

Only what a site writes about itself in the headers of its first page or in its generator tag is measured, so the figures are a floor, and sites behind a front such as Cloudflare do not announce their server.

79.2%	Announce their server	9,324 / 11,776
30.0%	Announce a software version	3,531 / 11,776
25.2%	Announce their content system	2,972 / 11,776
36.7%	Behind a front that hides the server	4,317 / 11,776

CIS Controls in the Arabian Gulf

Each figure is the share meeting the visible evidence, and it does not mean the safeguard is met, since most of what it asks happens inside and cannot be seen from outside.

Share	Visible evidence	Meeting of measured
9.5 Implement DMARC Implementation Group 2		
19.3%	DMARC enforced	2,663 / 13,797
70.1%	SPF in place	9,675 / 13,798
3.10 Encrypt Sensitive Data in Transit Implementation Group 2		
91.2%	Valid HTTPS	10,791 / 11,830
18.5%	HSTS for a year or more	2,185 / 11,830
86.9%	TLS 1.3 supported	10,284 / 11,830
69.5%	No TLS 1.0 or 1.1	7,968 / 11,472
52.5%	Post quantum ready	6,206 / 11,826
0.5%	MTA-STS enforced	52 / 10,871
16.2 Establish and Maintain a Process to Accept and Address Software Vulnerabilities Implementation Group 2		
1.9%	security.txt published	224 / 11,824
2.2 Ensure Authorized Software is Currently Supported Implementation Group 1		
76.1%	Announce a version still supported	2,603 / 3,422
7.4 Perform Automated Application Patch Management Implementation Group 1		
84.0%	On the latest release of their support cycle	2,876 / 3,422
7.7 Remediate Detected Vulnerabilities Implementation Group 2		
95.1%	Announce no version hit by an exploited vulnerability	1,886 / 1,983

CIS Controls® by the Center for Internet Security, Inc. Safeguard numbers, titles and Implementation Groups are used as CIS publishes them, unchanged, under CC BY-NC-ND 4.0.

Method and limits

The first page of every live domain is requested once, as any browser would, and its Server and X-Powered-By headers and the generator tag in its first 64 kilobytes are read, and nothing else is asked of the site.

The vulnerabilities come from CISA's catalogue of exploited vulnerabilities, the affected version ranges from NVD and the support cycles from endoflife.date, and all three are refreshed with every measurement.

It is measured after every weekly issue and within a day of a new entry for visible software, no domain is named and the states are never ranked.

A site can announce a version older than its code when its distribution backports the fixes, as Red Hat and Debian do, and it can announce only its major, in which case it is counted only when every version under it is affected or none is, so the share measures what a site announces, not exactly what runs inside it.

Each state has its own figures on its own page of the site, never set beside another, and no domain is named.

Sources

CISA Known Exploited Vulnerabilities catalogue · Read on 26 October 2026 cisa.gov/known-exploited-vulnerabilities-catalog

NVD, the National Vulnerability Database · Read on 26 October 2026 nvd.nist.gov

Support cycles on endoflife.date · Read on 26 October 2026 endoflife.date

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